



Vice President JD Vance speaks Sunday alongside Jared Kushner, left, and special envoy Steve Witkoff after meeting with Iranian officials.

JACQUELYN MARTIN/AP

Blockade of Iran announced after fruitless meeting

TRUMP DIRECTS NAVY TO CUT OFF HORMUZ

Sides can't reach deal in Islamabad; ceasefire tenuous

BY SUSANNAH GEORGE, NATALIE ALLISON AND SHAIQ HUSSAIN

ISLAMABAD, PAKISTAN — After marathon overnight talks between the United States and Iran failed to yield a deal on U.S. terms, President Donald Trump on Sunday announced the imposition of a naval blockade on Iran — a move that could derail a tenuous two-week ceasefire reached just five days ago.

“Effective immediately, the United States Navy, the Finest in the World, will begin the process of BLOCKADING any and all Ships trying to enter, or leave, the Strait of Hormuz,” Trump posted Sunday on Truth Social, his social

media site. The president also said he had instructed the Navy to interdict all ships that have paid a toll to Iran for traversing the strait, calling Tehran's expanded control of the waterway “EXTORTION.”

A U.S. official told The Washington Post that the U.S. and Iran failed to reach agreements on several U.S. demands, including that Iran end all uranium enrichment and allow the U.S. to retrieve its highly enriched uranium; the dismantling of all major nuclear enrichment facilities; accepting a broader de-escalation framework involving regional powers; ending funding for terrorist proxies including Hamas, SEE IRAN ON A11

Gas may not go as far at polls as Democrats hope

BY ERIN COX

LAS VEGAS — Tucked behind a luxury mall on the Vegas Strip, Carlos Galiote plugged his electric Ford Mustang into a rapid charger and explained why surging gas prices still sting.

He's barely taken out the family's gas-powered Volkswagen in a month. He already works two jobs to support five kids, driving for Uber during the day and waiting tables at night. And he expects Nevada's \$5-a-gallon to get costlier, part of broader inflation that leaves people “scared right now and desperate for a solution to all this.”

Democrats view swing voters

Swing-state voters' distrust of both parties could make issue moot

like Galiote, 39, as a key source of their political momentum in the midterms, hoping to harness the economic trouble under President Donald Trump and win power with a promise to make it better. But Galiote illustrates the challenge in that strategy: many voters don't trust politicians.

“Anyone can perform a beautiful speech nowadays. All you need is ChatGPT,” he said. “How

can you trust someone when each time, most people, they fail?”

In Nevada, with its high concentration of diverse working-class voters, Democrats see the battleground state as a testing ground for their party's central case in the midterms and beyond: Republicans broke their promise to tame prices but Democrats can do it, Nevada's swing voters have often punished the party in power during economic uncertainty, ousting Gov. Steve Sisolak in 2022 — the only incumbent Democratic governor to lose that year — and flipping the state red for Trump in the 2024 presidential race after backing

Biden four years earlier.

The spiking gas prices magnify the financial strain in Nevada, where the tourism-dependent economy can be an early indicator of downturn. Democrats see a fertile environment for their economic populist pitch to throw out the incumbents. But in interviews with more than a dozen voters across the Las Vegas region, nearly all were disillusioned, distrustful that a politician from either party would repair the damage.

That cynicism has potential to harm both parties at the ballot box. Republicans could see their disillusioned supporters stay SEE FUEL ON A13

BY NATALIE ALLISON

The involvement of Vice President JD Vance had raised hopes around the world that the weekend negotiations in Pakistan would solidify the ceasefire with Iran and put an end to the war within reach.

President Donald Trump's most high-profile war skeptic gave it some time: He traveled 18 hours to meet with Iran's negotiating team in Islamabad, the Pakistani capital. He engaged in talks for more than 20 hours. And he emerged Sunday morning lacking both sleep and a deal to end the war, ahead of the long journey back home.

But inside the negotiating room with Vance, special envoy Steve Witkoff and Trump's son-in-law Jared Kushner, U.S. officials say, progress was made on another front: establishing some measure of goodwill with officials of a country that has proved difficult to negotiate with or achieve mutual understanding with. That has led Trump, Vance and other top administration officials to believe that Iran may still come to accept their terms to end the deadly and costly war, some officials say.

“Well, good morning, everybody,” Vance said as he emerged from talks to address a room full of U.S. reporters who had also made SEE VANCE ON A11

Powerful surveillance program faces obstacles

Court ruling raises issues about government's use of the tool on Americans

BY ELLEN NAKASHIMA, WARREN P. STROBEL AND NOAH ROBERTSON

The powerful but controversial surveillance program known as Section 702 is about to expire, and its reauthorization faces political obstacles in the Republican-controlled Congress, despite the White House's backing.

Administration officials have credited Section 702 with helping to rescue American hostages overseas, enabling the seizure of fentanyl precursor chemicals from China and even preventing a terrorist attack at a Taylor Swift concert in Austria.

“When used properly, [Section 702] is an effective tool to keep Americans safe,” President Donald Trump said in a Truth Social post last month in the midst of war with Iran. “The fact is ... it is extremely important to our military. I have spoken to many generals about this, and they consider it vital.”

Trump wants to see an 18-month extension of the law with no changes, or what is known as a “clean” reauthorization.

First passed in 2008 as an

amendment to the Foreign Intelligence Surveillance Act (FISA), Section 702 allows national security agencies to gather the texts and emails of foreigners located overseas from U.S. communications providers, without a warrant.

Since Section 702 was passed, and with every subsequent renewal, it has met bipartisan opposition from lawmakers and activists who say the law violates constitutional privacy rights because it does not require a warrant to search the communications for data involving U.S. persons.

“Intelligence agencies must operate within the constitutional protections against warrantless searches against U.S. citizens,” Rep. Michael Cloud (R-Texas), a member of the conservative House Freedom Caucus, posted on X.

National security-minded lawmakers, however, say the tool is indispensable. “It is not hyperbole to say that allowing the 702 program to expire would result in grave damage to U.S. national security,” Rep. Jim Himes (Connecticut), the top Democrat on the House Intelligence Committee, said in a letter to colleagues.

The obstacles to a clean reauthorization appear most daunting in the House, where a number of Democrats and Republicans are insisting on changes, including one that would require a war-

SEE SURVEILLANCE ON A5

Amid assault claims, Swalwell suspends campaign

BY AMY B WANG AND LIZ GOODWIN

Rep. Eric Swalwell (D-California) is suspending his campaign for California governor two days after reports that a former staffer accused him of sexual assault and multiple other women alleged sexual misconduct.

“I am suspending my cam-

paign for Governor,” Swalwell wrote on X on Sunday evening. “To my family, staff, friends, and supporters, I am deeply sorry for mistakes in judgment I've made in my past.”

Swalwell continued to deny allegations of sexual assault against him.

“I will fight the serious, false allegations that have been made

— but that's my fight, not a campaign's,” Swalwell wrote.

Swalwell's abrupt exit from the California governor's race marks a remarkable downfall for the longtime congressman, who was considered a leading candidate. The fallout from reports of sexual assault and misconduct continued Sunday, as pressure mounted for Swalwell to also vacate his

congressional seat.

Several lawmakers on both sides of the aisle said Sunday they would support a motion to expel Swalwell from Congress, after Rep. Anna Paulina Luna (R-Florida) promised to force such a vote this week. Luna added Sunday she would try to pair that resolution with one that would also SEE SWALWELL ON A2



ANDREW REDINGTON/GETTY IMAGES

Rory repeats at Augusta

Rory McIlroy lets out a roar after holding off his challengers on a drama-filled Sunday at the Masters to win the tournament for the second straight year and become its fourth repeat champion. **Story, C1**

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